

Larkspur Home Robotics — Employee Handbook (2026 edition)

1. About this handbook

This handbook applies to all full-time and part-time employees of Larkspur Home Robotics (a fictional company used for demonstration purposes). It was last revised on 12 January 2026 and replaces all earlier versions.

Questions about any policy should go to the People Operations team at the internal help desk. Managers may not grant exceptions to the policies in sections 3 and 5 without written approval from People Operations.

2. Working hours and remote work

Core collaboration hours are 10:00 to 15:00 in the employee's local time zone. Outside core hours, employees organise their own schedule with their manager.

Employees may work remotely up to three days per week. Fully remote arrangements require a signed remote work agreement and are reviewed every six months. Employees working remotely receive a one-time home office allowance of 600 USD, paid with the first salary after the agreement is signed.

3. Paid time off

Full-time employees accrue 22 days of paid vacation per calendar year, prorated for part-time contracts. Up to five unused vacation days may be carried over to the next year; carried-over days expire on 31 March.

Vacation requests of more than five consecutive working days must be submitted at least 30 days in advance. Requests of five days or fewer need 7 days' notice.

In addition, employees receive 10 days of paid sick leave per year. A medical certificate is required for absences longer than three consecutive days. Sick leave does not carry over.

4. Parental leave

Primary caregivers receive 16 weeks of fully paid parental leave; secondary caregivers receive 6 weeks. Parental leave can be taken within 12 months of the birth or adoption and may be split into two blocks.

5. Expenses and travel

Business expenses are reimbursed when submitted with receipts within 45 days of the expense. Expenses above 250 USD require prior approval from the employee's manager.

Economy class is the standard for all flights. Business class is allowed only for flights longer than 8 hours and requires director approval. The daily meal allowance while travelling is 70 USD.

6. Information security

All laptops must use full-disk encryption and lock automatically after 5 minutes of inactivity. Multi-factor authentication is mandatory for every company system.

Suspected security incidents, including lost devices, must be reported to the security team within one hour of discovery. Customer data may never be stored on personal devices or personal cloud accounts.